

Perfecting an art

By C.G.S.Narayanan

Chess problemists generally strive for perfection in their compositions but practically due to various reasons it is not possible always to achieve the ideal. Eventually they settle for some acceptable position. But later it turns out that the position contains potential for improvement which we were reluctant to try earlier. Russian composer Andrei Lobusov possessed very high technique and excellent artistic taste and often improved the tasks of other authors, finding unused possibilities in positions. Look how he converts the ordinary problem below into a veritable masterpiece

Ya. Kishch, Yo. Segi

Yuk E. Virtanen, 1963 Special prize



Mate in two moves

Qf8?(2.Qc5) 1..Qxe5 2.Qb4 1...b6!
1.Qe8?(2.Bb6)1..Qxe52.Qa4 1...Bc7!
1.Qh5?(2.Bb6)1Qxe5 2.Qd1, 1..Bc7!
1.Qh7?(2.Qe4)1..Qxe52.Qd31..Qf4!
1.Qh6?(2..Qe3)1..Qxe52.Qd2,1...Qg3
! Qg8!2.Qd5,1...Qxe5!1.Qc4.

In six phases above we see move orders for mate in one move 1...Qxe5. Russian composer Andrei Lobusov reduced the number of phases to four, but added a variant with the black king on the same square e5.

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A.Lobusov

The Problemist, 1976 1st prize



Mate in two moves

1.Qf6? (2.Qd4), 1...Kxe4 2.Rd2,
1..Qxe4 2.Qc3, 1..Qd5!
1.Qxh5? (2.Qe2) 1...Kxe4 2.Rc4,
1.Qxe42.Qd11...Ng3!
1.Qf7?(Qc4)1...Kxe42.Re2
1...Qxe4 (2.Qb3), 1...Qg8!
1.Qg5! (2.Qe3)1...Kxe4 2.Rc3
1...Qxe4 2.Qd2.

Now we have Zagoruyko 4x2 with 12 different mates including threats are realized. The mechanism of the problem is very precise, everything works like clockwork. Overall, it turned out to be a quite original and interesting work which won premier honours. A splendid work of art!

The problem for solving below is the latest Indian success in 'Problemist'

C.G.S.Narayanan

2nd prize, The Problemist 2024



Mate in two moves

Solution to problem for solving in the article 'Prize winners of '64':

Key move 1.Ng4!

Readers may send in their queries to
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